

The Roman Catholic Charismatic Movement and Social Capital in Sub-Saharan Africa

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Abstract:

The Roman Catholic Charismatic Renewal (CCR) is a movement within the Catholic Church that has spread from North America and Europe to Africa, Latin America and Asia in the last several decades. Characterized by an emphasis on the power of the Holy Spirit to work through ordinary Christians, the CCR is a lay movement that has sometimes been described as “Pentecostal Catholicism” and has become immensely popular in many parts of sub-Saharan Africa. Given the different experiences of CCR members with methods of religious practice, involvement in group governance, and interaction with religious authority, how does participation in the CCR affect social, economic, and political attitudes and behavior in the region? Using original data collected by the authors in Kenya and Nigeria we find little evidence to indicate that the CCR is depressing civic engagement or political participation. In fact, we find that the CCR is actually increasing women’s political engagement in Kenya. We also do find evidence to suggest that the CCR is decreasing the social and political significance of ethnic identity, especially in Kenya, and increasing the social and political salience of religious identity.

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I. Introduction

Pentecostal and Charismatic Christian religious movements have grown dramatically in many regions of the world over the past several decades, including sub-Saharan Africa (Pew Report 2006; Barrett et al. 2001). These movements typically place strong emphasis on miracles, deliverance, and healing and focus on promoting openness to spiritual powers. Pentecostal and Charismatic religious groups typically demand of members a significant investment of time and, in some cases, financial resources. While initially drawing their membership from the poorest strata of societies in sub-Saharan Africa, these movements now draw from people of all social classes. Despite the growing popularity of such movements in the region, there has been little attention to their impact on the actions and attitudes of those who join them.

This paper seeks to discern the social and political impact of one such religious movement that exists within the Roman Catholic Church, the Roman Catholic Charismatic Renewal [CCR]. We seek to discover whether the CCR is discouraging or encouraging of the civic engagement and social tolerance that makes liberal democracy possible. In other words, we want to know whether the CCR is producing something that we might call social capital and whether that social capital is essentially bonding or bridging in nature (Coleman 1990). Bridging social capital connects members of a group to people beyond the group. Where there is bridging social capital, people become engaged in the wider society in all its plurality and are tolerant of people of different ethnic and religious groups (Dekker and Uslaner 2001; Uslaner 2001; Putnam 2000;1993). Bonding social capital connects people to the group, but not to those beyond the group. Where there is only bonding social capital, people essentially build their own separate society for themselves within the group so that there is little or no political engagement and tolerance of social differences.

Based on a mass survey and in-depth interviews conducted across different settings within Kenya and Nigeria, we find that the CCR does in some ways and in some locations produce bridging social capital, especially with regard to building greater tolerance among different Christian denominations and in reducing the salience of ethnic identity. At the same time, however, we do not find involvement in the CCR having a great effect on civic and political participation; with the exception of women in Kenya, among whom CCR has a positive effect on voting and participation in political rallies.

II. The Literature

While there is essentially no literature concerning the CCR and its impact on social capital, there have been a few studies that have focused on Pentecostal Christianity and its social and political impact. Most of these studies suggest that Pentecostal and Charismatic movements have become increasingly concerned with social and political influence in the wider society and have started to promote political activism but not necessarily social tolerance.

There is evidence to support the assertion that Pentecostal Christianity is less conducive to liberal democracy than mainline Christianity. When we look within countries we do find evidence to suggest that Pentecostal Christianity has not been as encouraging of liberal democratic values as mainline Christianity. For example, a study in Guatemala found a negative correlation between Pentecostal involvement and voting, community volunteerism, and social activism (Steigenga 2001). Marshall (2009) and Imo (2008) note that, in Nigeria, leaders of Pentecostal Christian and evangelical churches largely refrained from political activities during the 1970s and 1980s. However, these authors join others in claiming that this political quietism

has given way to political activism and a very strident, anti-democratic and illiberal Pentecostal political theology.

In Nigeria, Pentecostal political mobilization is at least partly a response to perceived efforts by Muslims to make Nigeria an Islamic state. Marshall (2009) makes reference to a “Born-Again political theology” that calls for enough individuals to be converted [i.e., become Born-Again Christians] so that society will be ordered as God wishes. This political theology calls for a born-again Christian to lead the country as president, not a nominal or mainline Christian and certainly not a Muslim (Kalu 2008). Marshall refers to the Born-Again project as a totalizing one that seeks to win people for Christ and to turn nations into Christian nations. Yong (2010) observes that Pentecostal political theology is anti-Islamic wherever there is a significant Muslim presence, as in Nigeria and other African countries, and anti-Catholic wherever there is a significant Catholic presence, as in many countries of Central and South America. Such a totalizing Pentecostal project does not sit well with many mainline Christians, not to mention Muslims, and is on a direct collision course with the religious totalitarianism promoted by many Islamists. Marshall (2009: 219) writes, “Islam, as a competing theocratic project violently excludes the possibility of national conversion [to Christianity].” The Pentecostal or Born-Again project has many points in common with radical reformist Islam, according to Marshall (Ibid.). Their political theologies are mutually exclusive.

However, there is evidence to indicate that the relationship between Pentecostalism and politics is more complex than some have suggested. In their 2006 survey, *Spirit and Power: A 10-Country Study of Pentecostals*, the Pew Forum found that a slightly smaller percentage of Pentecostal respondents than other Christian respondents supported freedom of speech in the United States and Latin America, but that that a slightly larger percentage of Pentecostals

supported freedom of speech to a greater degree than other Christians in the three African countries and three Asian countries included in the survey. The Pew study also found that there was virtually no difference between Pentecostals and other Christians in terms of their support for freedom of religion for religions other than their own across all 10 countries (Pew Forum 2006). While the Pew report's data does not allow us to go so far as to claim that Pentecostalism is promoting tolerance and respect for religious freedom in these countries, it does show that Pentecostal Christians are not necessarily less religiously tolerant than members of other Christian churches. In sum, there is evidence to suggest that Pentecostalism does not always and everywhere encourage or discourage actions and attitudes conducive to liberal democracy.

What about the CCR? It is important to note that, unlike Pentecostal churches the CCR, the subject of our study, is not a church but a movement *within* a church; and not just any church, but the Roman Catholic Church, with its well-developed social teaching on civic responsibility and social justice. Despite the similarities it shares with the Pentecostal churches, the impact of the CCR on civic engagement and social tolerance may be quite different. It is possible that the CCR not only serves to bond people who share a faith commitment, but serve to build bridges between Catholics of different ethnic groups and with non-Catholics. It is possible that membership in the CCR is empowering for civic engagement. In the following section, we briefly discuss hypotheses we test in this paper.

III. Theory and Hypotheses

The main question we pose in this paper is, are Nigerian and Kenyan Catholics who are members of the CCR any more or less civically engaged and socially tolerant than their fellow Nigerian and Kenyan Catholics who are not part of the CCR? Based on the literature and anecdotes gathered from our own experiences, we developed four hypotheses that we test in this paper:

H1: CCR members will be more religiously active than non-CCR Catholics in Kenya and Nigeria.

We expect that Catholics who are members of the CCR will be more religiously active than Catholics who are not members of the CCR. Membership in the CCR itself indicates an intense interest in spiritual and religious matters. Member of the CCR will be more likely to attend Catholic religious services and more participative on church committees than Catholics who are not members of the CCR.

H2: CCR members will participate in politics less often than non-CCR Catholics.

Either because of the substantial time commitment required of people who are members of the CCR and/or because the CCR encourages people to spiritualize social and political problems, we expect the CCR to discourage political participation. We expect that Catholics who are members of the CCR will be more focused on “other-worldly” matters than “this-worldly” matters. If people are concerned about social and political change at all, we expect them to pray for change rather than to actively/physically effect such change by voting, attending political rallies, or participating in protests.

H3: CCR members will be less tolerant of other Christians and Muslims than non-CCR Catholics.

We expect that members of the CCR will be less tolerant of religious differences than other Catholics. Precisely because of the similarities between the CCR and Pentecostal Christian churches and the degree to which they compete over people attracted to the same type of worship, we predict that members of the CCR will be less tolerant of Pentecostals. We expect that members of the CCR will seek to differentiate themselves from Pentecostals in an attempt to prevent Catholics from joining Pentecostal churches.

H4: The percentage of the population that is non-Christian will affect the impact of the CCR on religious tolerance.

If the non-Christian population is significant, we expect that the CCR will increase tolerance of other Christians, promote trust, and build bridges between different Christian groups. The CCR is likely to contribute to pan-Christian solidarity where Christians are in the minority. However, we expect the CCR in such settings not to promote tolerance of Muslims.

IV. Data and Methodology

In order to discern whether the CCR is producing bridging social capital in Kenya and Nigeria, we conducted a mass survey of Catholics who are members of the CCR and Catholics who are not, as well as non-Catholic Pentecostals in these countries in 2011.¹ The survey in Kenya was administered August 12 to September 1 and included 1,200 respondents

¹ This project is funded by the Pentecostal and Charismatic Research Initiative at the Center for Religion and Civic Culture at the University of Southern California.

who self-identified as either Catholic or Pentecostal Christians.² We surveyed respondents in areas surrounding two parishes each in Nairobi and Mombasa and one each in Eldoret and Nakuru. The survey in Nigeria was administered October 25 to November 2 and also included 1,200 self-identified Catholics and Pentecostal Christians.³ We surveyed respondents from areas surrounding two parishes each in Abuja, Enugu, and Kano, and one each in Lagos and Ibadan. These settings were chosen in large part because of the variation in their religious landscapes and, as noted above in H4, we expect that the religious mix of a particular setting will shape any effect that the CCR has on social capital, civic engagement, and tolerance of ethnic and religious differences.

The survey questionnaire consisted of items relating to religious participation and beliefs, as well as social, economic, and political attitudes and behaviors. Respondents in both countries were asked the same questions, with some variation depending on religious affiliation. For instance, Pentecostal Christians were not asked about attitudes toward the Catholic Church and non-CCR Catholics were not asked about activities related to membership in the CCR.

In the following sections, we report summary statistics on measures of religious attitudes and behaviors as well as measures of social capital. Our main measures of social capital include

² The survey was administered face-to-face using PAPI (Pen and Paper Interview) methodology with printed, structured questionnaires. The survey was carried out using 3 separate questionnaires, in English with Kiswahili translation, for the 3 target groups: Charismatic Catholic, Non-charismatic Catholic, and Pentecostal. Survey recruitment was done primarily through snowball sampling to facilitate recruitment of potentially difficult to reach respondents such as Charismatic Catholics. The researchers pre-selected sampling locations and parishes and provided them to Synovate Kenya, the organization that administered the survey. A total of 200 interviews were conducted in each parish.

³ The survey was administered using the same methodology as in Kenya (see footnote 1). The survey was carried out using 3 separate questionnaires, in English with Yoruba, Igbo and Hausa translation. A total of 300 interviews were conducted in each parish.

attendance at various types of political events and meetings, political discussion, and social tolerance. Following the summary statistics, we report the results of multiple regression analyses.

The dependent variables of interest in our study are measures of social capital, which include political and civic engagement and tolerance. To measure *political and civic engagement*, we examine the following attitudes and behaviors:

- Discussing politics with friends or neighbors
- Asking fellow believers to pray for a political issue
- Attending community meetings
- Attending demonstrations or protest marches
- Going to hear politicians try to rally support for their cause
- Voting in the recent constitutional referendum (in Kenya) or in the last general election (in Nigeria)

Responses are coded as binary variables, measuring whether or not respondents reported having done the activity in the past year. To measure *social tolerance*, we use questions that ask how comfortable respondents would be with various groups of people as their neighbors, including people of a different race, ethnicity, or tribe, Protestants, and Muslims. To further examine tolerance of Muslims—which is especially relevant in Nigeria, but also salient in Kenya—we use a question that asks how comfortable the respondent would be with a child of theirs marrying a Muslim. Responses are coded as binary variables, with 1 indicating intolerant (i.e. uncomfortable) responses.

Each regression model includes a number of additional variables and controls. The main independent variable we test is *membership in the CCR*. To account for religiosity, *frequent participation* is a dummy variable coded 1 for respondents who report participating in prayer

groups, bible study at least once a week or more often. Because trust is often included as a variable in studies of social capital, we use two measures. The first is an index of *interpersonal trust*, which includes how much respondents trust relatives, people in their neighborhood, people from other religions, and people from their own and other ethnic groups. *Political trust* is an index that measures how much respondents trust the national government, their city or local government, the military, the media, and Christian and Muslim political candidates. Arguably, the first is a better measure of social capital. Finally, we control for a number of demographic variables, including *sex*, *age*, *income*, and *education*. So that we can test H4, we also control for location of survey.

So that we might be in a better position to make causal inferences, we supplement the mass survey data with results from in-depth interviews conducted in both countries. These interviews asked people to explain how their religious convictions relate to their views of their civic responsibilities and their views of people who are of different ethnic and religious groups. In every Catholic parish where the mass survey was conducted, six parishioners who were Charismatic prayer group members were interviewed, three men three women. These Charismatic Catholics were randomly selected from separate lists of men and women who were members of the Charismatic prayer group in each parish. In each parish, Catholics who were not members of the Charismatic Renewal/who do not belong to a Charismatic prayer group were also interviewed, three men and three women. Using the two-household-skip method, they were selected randomly from households in the geographic area around each Catholic parish included in the study.

V. Findings

When it comes to communal religious involvement, survey results show that CCR members in Kenya and Nigeria are more religiously active than non-CCR Catholics. It is clear that the CCR members spend much more of their time participating in communal religious activities [not counting CCR prayer group meetings] than non-CCR members. CCR members attend religious services more frequently than non-CCR Catholics (Table 1). In Kenya, 74.8% of CCR members attend religious services more than once a week, compared to 36.3% of non-CCR Catholics. In Nigeria, 85.8% of CCR members attend religious services more than once a week, compared to 58.8% of non-CCR Catholics. CCR members also participate in prayer groups, bible study groups, or other religious programs more frequently than non-CCR Catholics in both countries. In Kenya, 85.7% of CCR members participate in these activities once a week or more often, compared to 59.5% of non-CCR members. In Nigeria, 85% of CCR members participate at least once a week or more often, compared to 56.4% of non-CCR Catholics. Non-CCR Catholics in both countries are also slightly less likely to participate in inter-faith religious groups, classes, or meetings with members of other religious groups than CCR members.

Reflecting the charismatic character of CCR practices, most CCR members in Kenya and Nigeria have experienced or witnessed a divine healing of an illness or injury and have experienced or witnessed the devil or evil spirits being driven out of a person (see Table 1). CCR members are also more likely to focus on the Holy Spirit, as seen in responses to a question asking respondents to describe their feelings about the Bible. Finally, CCR members in both countries are more likely to identify as “Christians” before other possible identities, including Catholic, Kenyan/Nigerian, African, or one’s tribe.

Confirming Hypothesis 1, we find CCR members in Kenya and Nigeria do differ in terms of their religious practices and beliefs from non-CCR Catholics. Results from in-depth interviews support the survey findings. CCR members report that being a member of a charismatic group is very time intensive and consuming. For example, in Abuja, Nigeria, there are meetings 3 nights a week (e.g. bible study on Mondays, ministry Meetings on Tuesdays, and prayer meetings on Wednesdays). Then, there are often other meetings for special needs on other days of the week.

The primary question this study aims to address is whether such differences among religious practices and experiences among CCR members affect their social, political, and economic attitudes and behaviors. If CCR members do spend a great deal of time engaged in CCR-related meetings and prayer, do they therefore have less time to devote to non-religious activities? Do the experiences and attitudes they develop in meetings affect how politically active and socially tolerant they will be in the wide society?

To explore these questions, we first report some summary statistics on measures of social capital that include political and civic engagement and tolerance. We then report the results of multiple regressions that control for various demographic measures. Table 2 contains the summary statistics. Patterns of participation and attitudes are similar across CCR and non-CCR Catholics in both Kenya and Nigeria. A larger percentage of CCR members have attended a community meeting, voted, and asked fellow believers to pray for a political issue, while more non-CCR members have attended a demonstration or protest or a political rally or discussed politics with friends or neighbors in the past year.

Patterns of intolerance are similar across the two countries, though rates differ, with greater intolerance toward all groups reported in Nigeria (see Table 2). In both countries, smaller

percentages of CCR members report being uncomfortable with various groups of people as their neighbors (including people of a different race, ethnicity, or tribe, Protestants, and Muslims). At the same time, a greater percentage of CCR members report being uncomfortable with their child marrying a Muslim, as compared to Catholics who do not belong to the CCR. The rates of intolerance are higher in Nigeria than in Kenya across all groups of respondents, but especially with regard to intolerance of Muslims. This reflects the greater salience of the Muslim-Christian conflict in Nigeria as compared to Kenya.

Are differences between CCR and non-CCR Catholics significant once we include variables that account for religiosity, trust, and demographics? Tables 3-4 report results of logistic regression analyses on measures of political participation. We perform separate analyses for each country. In each model, we cluster by survey location to account for systematic differences that may exist in demographics or other factors within each country (four clusters per country).

Table 3 reports regression results for the variables measuring political participation in Kenya. Controlling for other independent and demographic variables, Charismatic Catholics are less likely to attend demonstrations and rallies and to vote, but more likely to attend community meetings. However, only the coefficient for attending rallies is statistically significant.

Substantively, this means that holding other variables at their means, CCR members are 11% less likely to attend rallies than non-CCR Catholics. In Kenya, Charismatic Catholics are more likely to discuss politics and ask fellow believers to pray for political issues, though only the coefficient for the latter variable is statistically significant. CCR Catholics are 13% more likely to ask fellow believers to pray for political issues than non-CCR members, holding other variables at their means. Thus, membership in the CCR appears to have little impact on civic engagement. With

the exception of decreasing attendance at political rallies and increasing the extent to which people try to encourage people to promote political causes through prayer, the CCR in Kenya is neither depressing nor increasing the civic engagement in a significant way (Hypothesis 2).

However, religiosity is found to be significant in predicting some forms of political participation in Kenya. Catholics who frequently participate in prayer groups and bible study are less likely to attend demonstrations. More specifically, only 9% of CCR members who frequently participate in prayer groups and bible study have attended demonstrations in the past year. On the other hand, 21% of non-CCR members who did not frequently participate in prayer groups and bible study attended demonstrations. This could reflect the fact that individuals who spend a lot of time at religious meetings have less time to attend political events. However, the table shows that slightly more frequent religious participants (about 5%) report having discussed politics with friends and neighbors in the past year. This suggests the possibility that prayer groups and bible study sessions include political discussions, though that cannot be confirmed with the survey data.

There are mixed findings about the effects of trust on political participation in Kenya. Interpersonal trust was found to be statistically significant in predicting a greater probability of having voted and discussed politics in the past year. Political trust was found to be statistically significant only in predicting a greater probability of having attended demonstrations or protests in the past year. Finally, demographic variables performed largely as expected: females were less likely to participate politically, while those with higher levels of education were more likely to participate. The results for age and income were mixed.

In-depth interviews we conducted in Kenya suggested to us that the CCR actually empowers women to speak their minds and become civically engaged. Several women in Kenya

and Nigeria noted that before they joined the CCR, they were afraid to speak. However, since joining the CCR, they felt free to speak their minds.⁴ Thus, we became interested in discerning whether the CCR is empowering women to become politically engaged. To further explore the relationship between CCR membership, gender, and political participation, we retest the models in Table 3 with an interaction variable for female CCR members (see Table 3a). We find that while non-CCR Catholic females are less likely to engage in all of the forms of participation we measure, female CCR members are more likely to engage in these activities, though the results are only significant statistically in the cases of attending political rallies and voting. The models predict that 54% of female CCR members will attend rallies compared to 35% of female non-CCR members, and 86% of female CCR members are predicted to vote in elections, compared to 77% of non-CCR members.

Table 4 reports regression results for political participation in Nigeria. As in Kenya, the CCR seems to be neither depressing nor increasing political participation. In Nigeria, membership in the CCR and frequency of participation in prayer groups and bible study are not statistically significant in predicting participation among Catholics. In these models, demographic variables seem to be capturing much of the variation in participation, though trust is statistically significant with regard to attending rallies.⁵

We employ a slightly different method to analyze the effects of CCR membership on tolerance of people of different race, ethnicity, tribe, and religion. We hypothesize that

⁴ For example, one female member of the CCR in Nairobi said that she was afraid of being ridiculed by others and refrained from speaking until she joined the CCR. “Now, I know that Jesus is with me and I am not afraid. In the charismatic prayer group, we encourage one another. I believe I was delivered from a bad self-image,” she stated (Interviewed July 25, 2011).

⁵ We also tested the interaction effect of gender and CCR membership on political participation in Nigeria. The variable was not significant in any of the models, therefore we have not included the results in this paper.

differences in religious composition within the cities in which we conducted our surveys will affect levels of tolerance. For instance, in Kenya, Eldoret and Nakuru are predominantly Christian, while Mombasa is predominantly Muslim but religiously diverse. Nairobi is also predominantly Christian, though with a fair amount of religious diversity. In Nigeria, Abuja and Lagos are religiously diverse, while Kano is predominantly Muslim and Enugu is predominantly Christian. The question we seek to answer is whether CCR members in these regions are more or less tolerant of various groups of people in different demographic settings. For example, does membership in the CCR lead to greater intolerance of Protestants in majority Christian regions, where religious competition is likely to be between Christian groups? Does CCR membership affect tolerance of Muslims, especially in majority Muslim regions?

Results for regressions on measures of tolerance are reported in Tables 5 (Kenya) and 6 (Nigeria). The dependent variables are coded as dummy variables, with 1 indicating an intolerant response. These models account for fixed effects by including dummy variables for the different locations surveyed (the capital city in each country is the reference category). As in previous models, standard errors are clustered by location.

In Kenya, CCR members are predicted to be more tolerant/less intolerant of people of other races, ethnic groups, and tribes, as well as of Protestants (see Table 5). The results for the two variables measuring intolerance of Muslims are not statistically significant. Religiosity and trust are only statistically significant in the model in which comfort with people of a different race, ethnicity, or tribe as neighbors is the dependent variable.

Survey location does appear to be important in explaining differences in tolerance across respondents, as evidenced by statistically significant coefficients for almost all of the location variables. Holding all else constant, respondents in Mombasa are predicted to be more tolerant of

having people of another race, ethnicity, or tribe as neighbors, while respondents in Nakuru and Eldoret are predicted to be less tolerant. More interesting are the results for intolerance of Protestants and Muslims. For example, in predominantly Muslim Mombasa, CCR members are more tolerant of Protestant neighbors than non-CCR Catholics. While CCR membership is not statistically significant in predicting attitudes toward Muslims, Mombasa respondents are found to be more likely to be tolerant of Muslims as neighbors than Nairobi residents (the reference category), but less likely to be comfortable with their child marrying a Muslim. In a predominantly Muslim area, Catholics are more likely to actually have Muslims as neighbors, hence explaining the tolerant response to that question. On the other hand, this does not translate to intermarriage with Muslims, which requires Christians to renounce their faith. The intolerant response to a child marrying a Muslim holds in all of the locations we studied.

Membership in the CCR is not significantly related to tolerance in Nigeria, except with regard to Protestants as neighbors (Table 6). Moreover, frequent participants in prayer groups and bible study are predicted to be more tolerant of having Protestant neighbors. This may reflect experience with different types of people in such religious settings, which may increase tolerance. In predominantly Muslim Kano, respondents are more likely to be tolerant of Protestants than in religiously mixed Abuja (the reference category), indicating the potential of a Christian alliance against Muslim competitors. However, respondents are more likely to be tolerant of Muslims as neighbors in all of the locations compared to Abuja. Unlike Kenya, respondents in Enugu and Lagos are predicted to be more tolerant of their child marrying a Muslim than in Abuja.

VI. Conclusion

While there are good theoretical reasons to expect the CCR to depress the production of bridging social capital, we find little empirical evidence to support this assertion in Kenya or Nigeria. Controlling for other factors that are likely to affect civic engagement, members of the CCR are not significantly less likely to be civically engaged or to participate in politics than Catholics who are not part of the CCR. This is largely true regardless of the national or sub-national setting. However, we do find that the CCR is more likely to encourage association with other Christians where Christians are in the minority or where there is a significant non-Christian population.

The CCR does appear to decrease the social and political salience of ethnic identity. The movement seems to be producing bridging social capital that decreases the likelihood of violent ethnic conflict in both Kenya and Nigeria, where it has been a problem and continues to threaten political stability and the future of democratic institutions. The CCR does seem to decrease the tensions between members of different ethnic groups and increase the salience of common religious identity over ethnic differences. For example, after the 2007 post-election violence in Kenya, many non-CCR members in Nairobi told us that it was the members of the CCR who first started to hold meetings that included people from both KiKuyu and Luo ethnic groups [the two ethnic groups between which there existed the most tension and violent conflict].⁶

Although the CCR decreases the social and political salience of ethnic identity, it appears that it increases the social and political salience of Christian religious identity where there is a significant non-Christian population. This suggests that the CCR may be increasing rather than

⁶ Interviews with Catholics of Holy Cross Parish, Dandora [Nairobi], Kenya, July 27, 2011.

decreasing the likelihood of Christian-Muslim conflict in Kenya and, with perhaps more dire consequences, in Nigeria.

Finally, CCR membership appears to have a positive effect on political participation for women in Kenya. In-depth interviews confirm the empowering effects of participating in the CCR. However, we cannot help but wonder why the CCR is more empowering of women in Kenya than in Nigeria. Our observations from the field suggest that this may be because Catholic women who join the CCR in Nigeria are more likely to be civically engaged already than Catholic women in Kenya.

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Table 1: Religious Practices and Beliefs of Catholics in Kenya and Nigeria

	Kenya		Nigeria	
	<i>CCR Members</i>	<i>Non-CCR Members</i>	<i>CCR Members</i>	<i>Non-CCR Members</i>
Attend religious services once a week or more often	74.8	36.3	85.8	58.8
Participate in prayer groups, bible study groups, or other religious programs once a week or more often	85.7	59.5	85	56.4
Participate in inter-faith religious groups, classes, or meetings with members of other religious groups	54	41.6	63.8	59.8
Are active members of Small Christian Communities	92.4	59.3	86.4	56
Have experienced or witnessed a divine healing of an illness or injury	92	43	90	61
Have experienced or witnessed the devil or evil spirits being driven out of a person	86.6	43.2	83.6	63.2
Believe that “The Bible is the actual word of God, but is to be interpreted by the influence of the Holy Spirit, who shows individual believers what the words mean.”	65	39.8	50.2	36.2
Identify “Being Christian” as their most important identity	71.1	46.7	60.5	50.8
<i>Number of respondents</i>	<i>448</i>	<i>452</i>	<i>500</i>	<i>500</i>

Note: Figures are percentage of respondents within each category of religious adherent.

Table 2: Social Capital Measures for Catholics in Kenya and Nigeria

	Kenya		Nigeria	
	<i>CCR Members</i>	<i>Non-CCR Members</i>	<i>CCR Members</i>	<i>Non-CCR Members</i>
<i>Active Participation</i>				
Attended a community meeting	72.5	64.6	59.8	54.2
Attended a demonstration or protest	10	16.8	21.2	25.6
Attended a political rally	34.2	44.7	23	32.8
Voted	77.7	75.2	87.2	83
<i>Passive Participation</i>				
Discussed politics with friends or neighbors	76.8	78.3	83.6	87.8
Asked fellow believers to pray for a political issue	89.7	73.9	70	66.6
<i>Intolerance</i>				
Uncomfortable with people of a different race, ethnicity, or tribe as neighbors	0.9	6.2	13.2	14.2
Uncomfortable with Protestants as neighbors	1.4	4.4	6.4	7
Uncomfortable with Muslims as neighbors	20.5	21.6	52.8	54.9
Uncomfortable with child marrying a Muslim	74.9	57.1	89	82.4
<i>Number of respondents</i>	<i>448</i>	<i>452</i>	<i>500</i>	<i>500</i>

Note: Figures are percentage of respondents within each category of religious adherent.

Table 3: Logistic Regression Analysis on Political Participation Measures in Kenya

	<i>Attended community meeting</i>	<i>Attended demonstration or protest</i>	<i>Attended political rally</i>	<i>Voted</i>	<i>Discussed politics</i>	<i>Asked believers to pray</i>
CCR member	0.16 (0.029)	-0.31 (0.23)	-0.46* (0.20)	-0.44 (0.35)	0.04 (0.20)	0.93** (0.32)
Frequent prayer group/bible study	-0.05 (0.38)	-0.63* (0.34)	0.07 (0.22)	0.33 (0.25)	0.27*** (0.15)	0.56* (0.27)
Interpersonal trust	0.09 (0.05)	-0.02 (0.07)	-0.02 (0.04)	0.04*** (0.01)	0.06* (0.03)	0.04 (0.04)
Political trust	0.02 (0.03)	0.06** (0.02)	0.02 (0.02)	-0.03 (0.04)	-0.01 (0.03)	0.00 (0.03)
Female	-0.47*** (0.12)	-0.31 (0.22)	-0.95*** (0.11)	-0.21 (0.19)	-1.12*** (0.26)	-0.14 (0.22)
Age	0.05*** (0.01)	-0.01 (0.01)	-0.00 (0.01)	0.05** (0.02)	0.00 (0.01)	0.01 (0.01)
Income	0.03 (0.09)	-0.09** (0.03)	0.07 (0.04)	0.03 (0.04)	0.08 (0.07)	-0.09 (0.08)
Education	0.04 (0.10)	-0.05 (0.03)	-0.02 (0.02)	0.11* (0.06)	0.19** (0.05)	0.10* (0.04)
Constant	-2.93*** (0.97)	-1.02 (1.39)	0.29 (0.58)	-1.24* (0.61)	-0.52 (0.79)	-0.40 (0.78)
N	768	768	768	768	768	768
Pseudo R2	0.090	0.039	0.055	0.053	0.076	0.071

Note: Robust standard errors in parentheses. Standard errors are clustered by location.

Table 3a: Logistic Regression Analysis on Political Participation Measures in Kenya

	<i>Attended community meeting</i>	<i>Attended demonstration or protest</i>	<i>Attended political rally</i>	<i>Voted</i>	<i>Discussed politics</i>	<i>Asked believers to pray</i>
CCR member	0.12 (0.50)	-0.41** (0.16)	-0.86*** (0.16)	-0.78 (0.52)	-0.11 (0.34)	0.63 (0.55)
Frequent prayer group/bible study	-0.04 (0.38)	-0.62* (0.26)	0.10 (0.14)	0.35 (0.32)	0.28*** (0.05)	0.57 (0.31)
Interpersonal trust	0.09 (0.05)	-0.02 (0.08)	-0.02 (0.05)	0.04*** (0.00)	0.06* (0.03)	0.04 (0.04)
Political trust	0.02 (0.03)	0.06* (0.03)	0.02 (0.02)	-0.03 (0.04)	-0.01 (0.03)	0.00 (0.03)
Female	-0.51*** (0.04)	-0.39*** (0.08)	-1.34*** (0.22)	-0.51 (0.27)	-1.22*** (0.09)	-0.32 (0.27)
Female * CCR member	0.07 (0.17)	0.20 (0.50)	0.76*** (0.21)	0.58* (0.18)	0.22 (0.23)	0.54 (0.41)
Age	0.05*** (0.01)	-0.01 (0.01)	-0.00 (0.01)	0.05** (0.02)	0.00 (0.01)	0.01 (0.01)
Income	0.03 (0.08)	-0.10* (0.04)	0.07 (0.05)	0.03 (0.04)	0.08 (0.09)	-0.09 (0.08)
Education	0.04 (0.09)	0.06 (0.03)	-0.02 (0.02)	0.12** (0.04)	0.19** (0.06)	0.10** (0.03)
Constant	-2.91** (0.96)	-0.97 (1.51)	0.52 (0.87)	-1.04 (0.59)	-0.44 (0.35)	-0.27 (0.85)
N	768	768	768	768	768	768
Pseudo R2	0.090	0.040	0.061	0.056	0.077	0.073

Note: Robust standard errors in parentheses. Standard errors are clustered by location.

Table 4: Logistic Regression Analysis on Political Participation Measures in Nigeria

	<i>Attended community meeting</i>	<i>Attended demonstration or protest</i>	<i>Attended political rally</i>	<i>Voted</i>	<i>Discussed politics</i>	<i>Asked believers to pray</i>
CCR member	-0.08 (0.34)	-0.35 (0.25)	-0.42 (0.49)	0.13 (0.53)	-0.30 (0.38)	-0.01 (0.23)
Frequent prayer group/bible study	0.15 (0.36)	0.41 (0.41)	-0.04 (0.46)	0.46 (0.50)	-0.65 (0.60)	0.35 (0.32)
Interpersonal trust	0.03* (0.01)	-0.05 (0.02)	-0.08* (0.03)	-0.00 (0.09)	-0.01 (0.05)	0.03 (0.02)
Political trust	0.03 (0.02)	0.06 (0.05)	0.08*** (0.02)	-0.01 (0.07)	0.02 (0.07)	0.04 (0.02)
Female	-0.28 (0.17)	-0.42** (0.14)	-0.31 (0.22)	-0.39 (0.23)	-0.82*** (0.20)	0.03 (0.21)
Age	0.05*** (0.01)	0.00 (0.01)	0.00 (0.01)	0.03** (0.01)	0.01 (0.01)	0.02*** (0.01)
Income	0.04 (0.08)	0.06 (0.12)	0.16 (0.12)	0.16 (0.08)	0.03 (0.10)	0.15** (0.05)
Education	0.12*** (0.03)	0.05 (0.05)	0.03 (0.05)	0.23 (0.14)	0.18*** (0.05)	0.16** (0.06)
Constant	-2.78*** (0.64)	-1.74* (0.77)	-1.54** (0.53)	-1.51 (1.69)	1.30 (0.74)	-3.12*** (0.68)
N	734	734	734	734	734	734
Pseudo R2	0.066	0.024	0.037	0.069	0.057	0.049

Note: Robust standard errors in parentheses. Standard errors are clustered by location.

Table 5: Logistic Regression Analysis on Tolerance Measures in Kenya

	<i>Uncomfortable with people of a different race, ethnicity, or tribe as neighbors</i>	<i>Uncomfortable with Protestants as neighbors</i>	<i>Uncomfortable with Muslims as neighbors</i>	<i>Uncomfortable with child marrying a Muslim</i>
CCR member	-2.26*** (0.60)	-1.70*** (0.51)	-0.10 (0.22)	0.63 (0.33)
Frequent prayer group/bible study	0.74* (0.30)	0.49 (0.92)	0.31 (0.38)	0.56 (0.32)
Interpersonal trust	-0.12** (0.04)	-0.18 (0.09)	-0.03 (0.05)	-0.05 (0.03)
Political trust	0.01 (0.05)	-0.06 (0.09)	-0.05 (0.04)	-0.03 (0.01)
Female	0.36 (0.46)	-1.05*** (0.30)	0.10 (0.15)	-0.13 (0.19)
Age	0.02 (0.02)	0.02 (0.03)	-0.00 (0.01)	0.00 (0.01)
Income	-0.01 (0.07)	-0.16*** (0.04)	0.06 (0.12)	0.18* (0.08)
Education	-0.08 (0.14)	-0.25 (0.31)	-0.19 (0.10)	0.01 (0.03)
Mombasa	-1.51*** (0.15)	-1.67*** (0.16)	-1.14*** (0.22)	0.56*** (0.13)
Nakuru	0.35*** (0.05)	-0.85*** (0.11)	0.01 (0.01)	0.19*** (0.02)
Eldoret	0.69*** (0.08)	-0.18 (0.11)	0.03 (0.09)	0.30*** (0.05)
Constant	-1.54* (0.68)	2.51 (2.30)	0.51 (1.21)	0.04 (0.16)
N	768	756	762	761
Pseudo R2	0.141	0.160	0.047	0.073

Note: Robust standard errors in parentheses. Standard errors are clustered by location. Nairobi is the reference category.

Table 6: Logistic Regression Analysis on Tolerance Measures in Nigeria

	<i>Uncomfortable with people of a different race, ethnicity, or tribe as neighbors</i>	<i>Uncomfortable with Protestants as neighbors</i>	<i>Uncomfortable with Muslims as neighbors</i>	<i>Uncomfortable with child marrying a Muslim</i>
CCR member	0.14 (0.31)	0.41* (0.19)	-0.01 (0.34)	0.43 (0.51)
Frequent prayer group/bible study	-0.32 (0.27)	-0.77* (0.32)	0.24 (0.14)	0.37 (0.30)
Interpersonal trust	-0.03 (0.03)	-0.11 (0.06)	-0.00 (0.04)	0.06* (0.02)
Political trust	-0.08* (0.04)	0.03 (0.03)	-0.07* (0.03)	-0.05* (0.02)
Female	0.01 (0.34)	0.05 (0.25)	-0.13 (0.25)	0.42 (0.33)
Age	0.01 (0.03)	-0.02 (0.02)	0.00 (0.00)	-0.00 (0.01)
Income	-0.24 (0.13)	-0.29*** (0.08)	-0.14 (0.12)	-0.02 (0.10)
Education	-0.02 (0.05)	-0.03 (0.03)	-0.11*** (0.03)	0.03 (0.06)
Enugu	0.78*** (0.11)	0.07 (0.14)	-0.27*** (0.04)	-0.44*** (0.09)
Lagos	-0.33 (0.22)	0.80*** (0.09)	-2.04*** (0.06)	-0.87*** (0.09)
Kano	0.31 (0.17)	-0.54*** (0.13)	-0.39*** (0.10)	0.28 (0.15)
Constant	0.56 (1.12)	1.36 (1.17)	3.02*** (0.63)	1.14 (0.66)
N	734	733	733	729
Pseudo R2	0.070	0.075	0.109	0.060

Note: Robust standard errors in parentheses. Standard errors are clustered by location. Abuja is the reference category.